From Compounding to Aspiring Flavourist

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Abstract

Over five months at ADM Singapore, I progressed from struggling with basic flavour compounding to becoming a reliable member of the Flavour Creation team. This internship developed my technical competencies while strengthening essential workplace skills, collaborations with colleagues, systematic problem-solving, and learning from failure.

Learning Objectives Achieved:

- Integrate FST knowledge into industry practice
- Develop technical competencies across multiple applications
- Build professional judgment and workplace skills
- Learn systematically from setbacks and feedback

Key Responsibilities

Flavour Compounding

Accurately weighing and mixing raw materials according to formulas, adhering to ± 1 % tolerance, while developing chemical intuition for troubleshooting.

Sampling & Dispatch

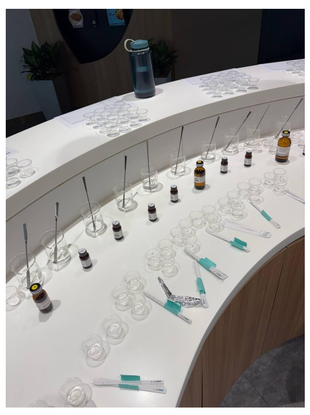
Preparing flavour samples for Product Development & Application (PD&A) prototypes and dispatching to regional APAC clients.

Inventory Management

Maintaining raw materials and flavour inventory to prevent delays and meet client deadlines.

Sensory Evaluation

Preparing samples, dosing flavours into appropriate bases, and participating in evaluation panels across beverage, dairy, confectionery, and savoury categories.



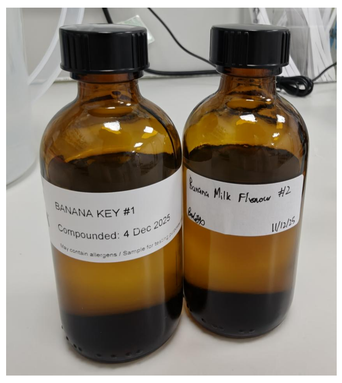
Ask Me Anything!

About my internship in the QR code

Portfolio Highlights

1. Banana Flavour Creation

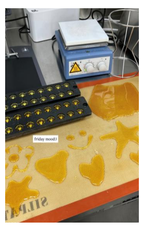
The culmination of my internship: creating banana and banana milk flavours that integrated all my learnings from the internship. This project confirmed that flavour creation is where my interests and career aspirations converge.



2. Cross-Departmental Collaboration

Rapidly adapted to different workflows and learnt from different specialists during various attachments across Beverage, Savoury, Confectionery, and Analytical teams. These experiences broadened my understanding of how flavours perform across diverse matrices and strengthened my ability to collaborate effectively under tight project timelines.

Savoury



Confectionery

Beverage

3. Problem-Solving Under Constraints

Developed a proactive, systematic approach to troubleshooting: anticipating issues before they arose and iterating methodically when faced with real-world constraints. This mindset became foundational to my work, enabling me to overcome challenges that come my way.

Lessons Learned

'Measure Twice, Cut Once'

Developing a systematic approach to tasks, prioritising clarity, and asking for help where necessary before execution.

Learning from Failure

Viewing setbacks as learning opportunities to better oneself instead of dwelling on it.

Pragmatism over Perfection

Ideal conditions rarely exist in the workplace. Learning to deliver quality results despite limited resources, time pressure, and practical constraints, without compromising on what matters was key.

Customer-Centric Mindset

Technical excellence means little if it doesn't meet customer needs. Keeping client specifications and timelines at the centre of my work ensured I delivered real value.

Cross-functional Collaboration

Collaborating effectively with specialists from diverse backgrounds to achieve shared goals under tight project timelines.

Discerning Valuable Feedback

Not all feedback is equally useful. Learning to filter out constructive input was essential for improvement.

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